

Essentials of Engaged Contemplation: Continuing to Walk the Path of Transformation

We hope that the Essentials of Engaged Contemplation offered you wisdom and practices that helped you take the next step in your spiritual journey. As you seek to continue the transformation through loving action, we would like to offer some questions and resources that might help you along the way.

Discernment Resources:

[*6th Core Principle of CAC*](#) by Fr. Richard

Active Hope by Joanna Macy

Let your Heartbreak be your Guide by Adam Bucko

Ignatian Discernment Practice

Do I Stay Christian; Find the Flow (Chapter 24) by Brian McLaren

Jesus and the Disinherited by Howard Thurman

Discernment Questions:

How am I being called toward solidarity with the suffering of the world?

How do I plan to stay grounded as I engage in loving action and witness the suffering of the world?

Do I feel led to meet the needs of those most directly affected by unjust systems? (example: supporting those experiencing homelessness or those experience domestic violence)

Do I feel led to challenge the dominant systems to be more just and loving? (example: organizing, non-violent protest, or running for office)

Do I feel led to participate in or build communal structures where people can embody their deepest values? (example: joining sustainable energy co-op or finding neo-monastic community)

Do I feel led to support others in their personal transformation? (example: teaching centering prayer or offering spiritual direction)

How does my loving action support what Fr. Richard calls a [*bias towards the bottom*](#) rather than the idealized and defended 'top'?

What might I have to learn about myself as I stand in solidarity with those who suffer?

Practical Questions:

What kind of resources do I have to offer? (Time, money, knowledge, relationship, etc.)

What skills do I have that could contribute to a more just and connected world?

What cause or issue am I feeling called to loving action on?

Who are mentors and guides I can learn from in my own context?

Where is work happening locally that I can come alongside?

Do I want to work in a faith-based, inter-faith, or secular context?

What cultural competencies or skills might be required to do the type of work I feel led to?

What do I need to learn to grow my competency and expose any biases?

Opportunities for Continuing Transformation

We want to share several organizations whose work provides opportunities for continued transformation. This list is not exhaustive or prescriptive, but rather a list that offers an opportunity for continued transformation across the US. We recognize that this list will *not* provide opportunity for *all* students who read it in their local context, particularly for international students. We also do not expect every student to engage with these organizations. Many of you are already connected with organizations doing good work. These are simply organizations that CAC is partnering with that offer opportunities for continued formation, community, and action that complement CAC's mission.

[Franciscan Action Network](#) - FAN does Franciscan hearted activism and advocacy.

[Poor People's Campaign](#) - Founded by Martin Luther King Jr., PPC is leading the call for national moral revival

[Inter-faith Power and Light](#) - IPL puts faith into action for a safe climate

[Laudato Si Movement](#) - Laudato Si Movement is mobilizing the Catholic community for common good

[New Conversation Initiative](#) - NCI is helping groups tell stories through non-judgmental engagement across political difference to build a more empathetic world

[Amplify Peace](#) - AP is a women-led group of peacemakers leading immersive encounters

[Center for Spiritual Imagination](#) - CSI shares the gifts of the Christian contemplative tradition by forming persons and communities

[Wisdom & Money](#) - W & M helps people engage with money from a mystical heart

[Shalem Institute](#) - Shalem seeks to nurture contemplative spirituality and living

[Contemplative Outreach](#) - Founded by Fr. Thomas Keating, CO seeks to living the contemplative dimension of the gospel through commitment to centering prayer

[Spiritual Director's International](#) - SDI is an international network of spiritual seekers offering programs to support deep listening and presence across all traditions

[Henri Nouwen Society](#) - HNS is dedicated to sharing the spiritual wisdom and teaching of Henri Nouwen

[Journey Home](#) - JH offers pilgrimages for those looking to heal soul and society

[Happy Givers](#) - HG seeks to lovingly provide meals, homes, and jobs to those most affected by unjust systems